Cyber Threat Intelligence Report

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Subject: How does a trojan horse get in my pc and what are the fixes

Overall risk: High (8.0/10), likelihood Likely, P2 - High

1. Executive Summary

An incident involving advanced techniques such as PowerShell exploitation, obfuscated files, credential dumping, network scanning, tool transfer, and ransomware encryption has been identified. The risk assessment indicates a high threat level (8.0/10) with a likely likelihood and priority P2 – high. The business impact includes financial loss and operational disruption, and the response must be initiated within 24 hours. Immediate actions include isolating compromised workstations and servers to stop lateral movement and command-and-control communication, terminating malicious processes like gaze.exe and suspicious PowerShell scripts, and deleting or quarantining malicious files such as gaze.exe, mimilib.dll, and PDQ Deploy scripts.

2. Threat Overview

Threat type: Not found in retrieved context.

Malware: Not found in retrieved context.

Attack summary

Not found in retrieved context.

Indicators of compromise

• Not found in retrieved context.

Affected systems

• Not found in retrieved context.

3. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Attack flow: Execution -> Defense Evasion -> Credential Access -> Discovery -> Command and Control -> Impact

ID	Technique	Tactic	Confidence
T1059.001	PowerShell	Execution	0.95
T1027	Obfuscated Files or Information	Defense Evasion	0.9
T1003	OS Credential Dumping	Credential Access	0.95
T1046	Network Service Scanning	Discovery	0.9
T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	Command and Control	0.85
T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	Impact	0.95

4. Risk Assessment

Severity: High (8.0/10)

Likelihood: Likely

Priority: P2 - High

Business impact

• Financial loss

• Operational disruption

Affected assets

• Workstations

• Servers

Justification

The observed techniques include credential dumping, AES-256 file encryption and service termination, which can cause substantial financial loss and downtime. Opportunistic scanning and a reported 10?% annual chance of ransomware attacks make infection likely, supporting a high severity rating.

5. Mitigation Plan

Response urgency: Act within 24 hours.

Immediate actions

• Isolate compromised workstations and servers from the network - Stops lateral movement and C2 communication associated with Ingress Tool Transfer (T1105) and ransomware encryption (T1486) (T1105, T1486)

• Terminate malicious processes such as gaze.exe and any suspicious PowerShell scripts - Halts execution of the ransomware payload and PowerShell-based obfuscation observed in the incident (T1059.001, T1105)

• Delete or quarantine malicious files (gaze.exe, mimilib.dll, PDQ Deploy scripts) - Removes the tools used for execution, credential dumping and file transfer (T1027, T1003)

• Reset compromised credentials and enforce privileged account management - Mitigates credential theft performed by Mimikatz (mimilib.dll) (T1003)

• Enable PowerShell Script Block Logging (Event ID 4104) and enforce execution policy - Detects and blocks encoded/obfuscated PowerShell commands used by the adversary (T1059.001)

• Restore encrypted files from known good backups after verifying integrity - Recovers data encrypted with AES-256 and mitigates impact of ransomware (T1486)

Prevention

• Apply security patches promptly to all operating systems and software - Reduces exploitable vulnerabilities that enable initial access and scanning

• Implement application whitelisting and code signing for executables - Prevents unauthorized tools like gaze.exe and PDQ scripts from running

• Enforce least-privilege and privileged account management policies - Limits ability of tools such as Mimikatz to dump credentials (T1003)

• Disable or restrict use of certutil, bitsadmin, and other native utilities for file download - Blocks common ingress tool transfer mechanisms (T1105)

• Deploy network segmentation and intrusion prevention systems to block internal port scans - Stops network service scanning (T1046) and limits lateral movement (T1046)

• Maintain regular, offline, immutable backups of critical data - Ensures recovery capability against data encryption attacks (T1486)

Detection

• Monitor for high-entropy or base64-encoded PowerShell command lines and alert on bypass flags - Detects obfuscated PowerShell payloads used in the attack (T1059.001)

• Alert on creation of files from external sources or unusual locations (e.g., System32) - Catches ingress tool transfer such as PDQ Deploy copying gaze.exe (T1105)

• Detect credential dumping activity by monitoring access to LSASS and loading of mimilib.dll - Identifies OS Credential Dumping behavior (T1003)

• Log and alert on internal hosts contacting many ports or hosts in short timeframes - Identifies network service scanning activity (T1046)

• Watch for mass file modifications, new file extensions, and ransom note files - Signals ransomware encryption phase (T1486)

• Enable PowerShell transcription and script block logging to capture full command history - Provides forensic evidence and real-time detection of malicious scripts (T1059.001)

Recovery

• Reimage affected systems from clean baselines after ensuring removal of malicious artifacts - Guarantees that no residual malware remains

• Restore data from verified backups and verify file integrity before bringing systems back online - Recovers encrypted data and minimizes downtime

• Rotate all privileged credentials and enforce strong password policies - Mitigates risk from previously dumped credentials

• Conduct a post-incident review to update detection rules and hardening controls - Improves future resilience based on observed TTPs

• Communicate with stakeholders about the incident and remediation steps taken - Ensures transparency and aligns response actions

• Validate that PowerShell logging and endpoint behavior prevention are fully operational - Confirms that detection/prevention measures are active for future attacks

ATT&CK mitigation reference

Technique	ATT&CK mitigations	Detection guidance
T1059.001 PowerShell	M1049 Antivirus/Antimalware, M1045 Code Signing, M1042 Disable or Remove Feature or Program, M1038 Execution Prevention, M1026 Privileged Account Management, M1021 Restrict Web-Based Content	Enable PowerShell Script Block Logging (Event ID 4104) and alert on encoded commands or download cradles.
T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information	M1049 Antivirus/Antimalware, M1040 Behavior Prevention on Endpoint	Flag high-entropy or encoded scripts and packed binaries; scan decoded content with AV/EDR.
T1003 OS Credential Dumping	M1026 Privileged Account Management, M1027 Password Policies, M1015 Active Directory Configuration, M1040 Behavior Prevention on Endpoint	Monitor access to credential stores and use of credential-dumping tools.
T1046 Network Service Scanning	M1031 Network Intrusion Prevention, M1030 Network Segmentation, M1042 Disable or Remove Feature or Program	Detect internal port-scan patterns, such as one host contacting many hosts or ports.
T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer	M1031 Network Intrusion Prevention	Monitor file downloads by certutil, bitsadmin, curl and PowerShell, and file creation from unusual external sources.
T1486 Data Encrypted for Impact	M1053 Data Backup, M1040 Behavior Prevention on Endpoint	Alert on mass file modification or renaming, new file extensions and ransom notes; deploy canary files.

6. Evidence and Sources

Cited by the agents

• cisa-vulnerability-review-fy-2024-2025.pdf, page 3 - Likelihood of ransomware attacks and potential financial loss

• 260818.pdf, page 18 - Data encryption and ransom demand

• 260818.pdf, page 14 - Credential dumping and tool transfer

• 260818.pdf, page 7 - Obfuscation and defense evasion techniques

• 260818.pdf, page 8 - Base64-encoded PowerShell payloads and bypass execution flags

Other retrieved passages

• 260818.pdf, page 2

• cisa-vulnerability-review-fy-2024-2025.pdf, page 6

7. Limitations and Assumptions

• Trojan horses are delivered via phishing emails or malicious downloads, which is not explicitly documented in the provided evidence

• LLM score 7.5 was outside +/-2.0 of the baseline 10.0; clamped to 8.0.

• The trojan horse was delivered via a phishing email or malicious download, which is a common vector but not explicitly documented in the provided evidence

• Endpoint protection solutions (AV/EDR) are deployed and can enforce the recommended mitigations

• This report was generated automatically. Findings should be reviewed by a security analyst before action is taken.

Appendix A: Analysis Plan

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THREAT TYPE:
Trojan horse

INFORMATION NEEDED:
- Common infection vectors and delivery methods for trojan horses
- Typical behaviors and indicators of compromise (IOCs) exhibited by trojan horses
- Recommended detection, removal, and prevention measures (fixes)

AGENTS TO ACTIVATE:
1. Threat Analyzer — to identify how trojan horses enter a system, their behaviors, and IOCs
2. MITRE Mapper — to map the identified behaviors to ATT&CK techniques for context
3. Mitigation — to provide actionable fixes, detection, and prevention steps

RETRIEVAL PLAN:

STEP 1:
Agent: Threat Analyzer
Retrieve: Detailed information on trojan horse infection vectors, delivery mechanisms, and typical
behaviors/IOCs
Search query: "trojan horse infection vectors delivery methods indicators of compromise"
Purpose: Establish how a trojan horse can get into a PC and what it looks for

STEP 2:
Agent: MITRE Mapper
Retrieve: ATT&CK technique mapping for trojan horse behaviors identified by Threat Analyzer
Search query: "trojan horse ATT&CK mapping"
Purpose: Provide structured context for the threat and link to known tactics and techniques

STEP 3:
Agent: Mitigation
Retrieve: Detection methods, removal procedures, and preventive best practices for trojan horses
Search query: "trojan horse mitigation removal steps best practices"
Purpose: Deliver concrete fixes and preventive actions

DEPENDENCIES:
- MITRE Mapper depends on the output of Threat Analyzer (needs identified behaviors to map)
- Mitigation depends on both Threat Analyzer (for specific behaviors) and MITRE Mapper (for technique
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context) to tailor fixes appropriately
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Appendix B: Agent Execution Status

Agent	Status
MITRE Mapper	success
Risk Assessment	success
Mitigation	success